

Front Desk Check-In & VIP Arrival Procedure

Company: Harbor Hotel Group | Doc ID: FOH-CHK-011 | Version: 2.3 | Effective: 2026-02-01 | Owner: Front Office Operations

Purpose & scope

Standard for front desk agents at Harbor Hotel Group properties during standard check-in, early arrival, late arrival, and VIP / loyalty tier arrivals (Harbor Gold and Harbor Platinum).

Key terms

Pre-reg: Reservation confirmed; room assigned; key packets prepared before guest arrival.

Upsell moment: After confirming reservation — offer upgrade only if inventory and rate rules allow.

VIP trace: CRM notes on preferences (pillow type, minibar, newspaper, allergy).

Standard procedure

1. Acknowledge guest within 20 seconds of approaching desk — eye contact and welcome by property name.
2. Request reservation name and photo ID; locate folio in PMS (HarborOne).
3. Confirm dates, room type, rate; read back total and incidentals hold amount.
4. For VIP tiers: acknowledge status by name ("Welcome back, Ms. Chen — Platinum member"); confirm VIP trace items.
5. Explain key cards, Wi-Fi, breakfast hours, gym location — max 45 seconds unless guest asks more.
6. Bell staff offer for luggage; escort to elevator for Platinum if policy active.

Approved phrases

"Good evening and welcome to Harbor Hotel Boston. May I have the name on the reservation?"

"I've upgraded you to a harbor-view king as a Platinum benefit — your keys are ready."

"We have a package waiting for you — I'll have it sent to your room within ten minutes."

"Checkout is at eleven, but I can note a late checkout subject to availability tomorrow morning."

Scenarios

Scenario A — Early arrival, room not ready: Guest arrives 9 AM; room dirty. Agent stores luggage, offers lobby coffee voucher, texts when room ready; never quotes exact time unless housekeeping confirms.

Scenario B — Overbooking: Walk-in with confirmed reservation; no room clean. Agent apologizes, offers partner hotel transport + comp night certificate per policy OB-001; manager approval required.

Scenario C — VIP allergy trace: Platinum guest with nut allergy noted. Agent confirms kitchen alert, removes minibar items with nuts before key handoff.

Escalation matrix

Trigger	Action
Rate dispute	Duty manager
Security concern (fake ID)	Manager + security
Guest injury in lobby	Incident report + GM notification
Media / celebrity	GM pre-approved privacy protocol

Do / Don't

Do: Stand when guest approaches; use guest name three times during interaction; smile in phone voice for call-ahead arrivals.

Don't: Discuss room numbers aloud when other guests wait; promise upgrades without system authorization; share other guests' stay information.